University of St.Gallen

Course and Examination Fact Sheet: Spring Semester 2026

8,027: Sustainable Corporate Strategies and Solutions

ECTS credits: 3

Overview examination/s

(binding regulations see below)
decentral - Written examination, Analog, Individual work individual grade (40%, 50 mins.)
Examination time: Term time
decentral - Presentation, Analog, Group work group grade (40%)
Examination time: Term time
decentral - Active participation, Analog, Individual work individual grade (20%)
Examination time: Term time

Attached courses

Timetable -- Language -- Lecturer
8,027,1.00 Sustainable Corporate Strategies and Solutions -- English -- Vuichard Pascal

Course information

Prerequisites

None.

Learning objectives

Upon the completion of this course, students will be able to:

1. Identify emerging trends and opportunities within the corporate sustainability landscape and apply strategic frameworks to drive innovation and adoption of low-carbon technologies within businesses.
2. Critically evaluate the environmental, social, and economic impacts of greentech solutions and reflect on how corporate decisions influence the net zero transition.
3. Analyze and understand consumer behavior to enable the development of scalable and effective greentech solutions that align with sustainable corporate strategies.
4. Apply strategic tools for assessing the impact of climate change on firms, consumers and financial markets for developing successful corporate strategies to hedge against climate risk and embrace low-carbon business opportunities.

Content

Climate change stands as the most pressing challenge of our time, with far-reaching implications for today and tomorrow. While businesses play a significant role in contributing to climate change, they also suffer from its consequences. Yet, amidst these challenges, acting on climate change presents great business opportunities.

This course offers a comprehensive, interactive and multi-disciplinary exploration of the threats, challenges, and opportunities that await on the path to achieving Net Zero. With decarbonization emerging as a new economic engine, companies that embrace bold and innovative action stand to unlock substantial opportunities. Throughout the course, participants will delve into various aspects crucial for corporates embarking on their journey towards Net Zero. From understanding regulatory frameworks to identifying the commercial and environmental business case of low-carbon solutions, every angle will be thoroughly examined.

By joining this course, you will gain important insights into the business case for adopting low-carbon solutions and acquire essential management tools needed to lead the charge for change. Join us and position yourself at the forefront of this transformative journey.

Structure and indications of the learning and teaching design

- This course counts 3 credits. Accordingly, the total workload for students is 90 hours. This includes self-study, campus time and all examinations.
- The structure of the contact study is planned as follows: A total of 18 hours of lectures within 8 sessions on campus and at least 2 hours of personal coaching and 2 hours of excursions/guest lectures.
- The structure of the self-study is intended as follows: 56 hours of preparation time for the lectures and the corporate sustainability solutions pitch and 10 hours for the examination and 2 hours for the examination part.
- The course is conducted in presence in St. Gallen.

This course is for you if:

1. You want understand the role climate change has on every company's and professional's role today;
2. You want to explore real-world innovation and design strategies that can enhance long-term organizational and professional resilience;
3. You want to understand how to change business models for long-term value, and drive change toward a net zero future.

Below, a more detailed overview of the different topics covered throughout the course (subject to change):

Session 1

Module 1a: Introduction

- Welcome and course introduction
- Details on group assignment "Corporate Sustainability Solutions Pitch" and overall assessment
- What are you curious about in relation to corporate sustainability?

Module 1b: Why do we have an interest to act on climate as companies: Primer in science of climate change

- The Science of climate change
- What are the key drivers and impacts of climate change?
- What are the implications for the business world?

Module 1c: Setting the scene – corporate sustainability in a polarized world

- Corporate sustainability in times of geopolitical confrontation
- Hype cycle and s-curves – exciting times
- Acting on climate – a strong economic value creation driver

Session 2

Module 2a: Strategic Driver for Corporate Sustainability I: The Role of Policy and Regulation

- A closer look at some key policy areas for greentech innovation
- Deep-dive into market-based mechanisms
- Discussion about the effectiveness of corporate sustainability policies so far

Module 2b: Group Project Coaching Session

- Coaching for your group projects – ensuring you are on the right track
- Inputs on any questions, tips and tricks

Session 3

Module 3a: Strategic Driver for Corporate Sustainability II: Addressing & Mitigating Climate Risks

- Climate risks – what are those and how can we assess them
- The role of corporate's and how to mitigate climate risks
- The role of banks

Module 3b: Part I - Strategic Driver for Corporate Sustainability; III: Creating Value through integrating Corporate Sustainability Solutions into Business Models

- A closer look at the Corporate Net Zero Strategy journey
- How companies are progressing on their Net Zero journey and how they adopt greentech solutions

Session 4

Module 4a: Quiz – Covering Sessions 1-3

- 40min quiz with multiple choice and short-answer based questions

Module 4b: Part II - Strategic Driver for Corporate Sustainability III: Creating Value through integrating Corporate Sustainability Solutions into Business Models

- A closer look at the Corporate Net Zero Strategy journey
- How companies are progressing on their Net Zero journey and how they adopt greentech solutions

Module 4c: Group Project Coaching Session

- Coaching for your group projects – ensuring you are on the right track
- Inputs on any questions, tips and tricks

Session 5

Module 5: Part I - The Greentech Innovation Landscape – an Overview

- A look at key areas of greentech solutions
- Focus Energy, Food, Carbon Removal and others
- Geographic implications of greentech innovation

Session 6

Module 6: Part II - The Greentech Innovation Landscape – an Overview

- A look at key areas of greentech solutions
- Focus Energy, Food, Carbon Removal and others
- Geographic implications of greentech innovation

Session 7

Module 7: Corporate Sustainability Solutions – Investor Pitch Session

- Your Investor Pitch Presentations
- Detailed schedule to be announced

Session 8

Module 8: The Role of Consumers in driving Greentech Innovation & Course Wrap-Up

- Low-carbon consumer behavior
- What is needed to drive greentech innovations among consumers?
- A look into behavioral science
- Course wrap-up

Literature

Selected reading materials will be uploaded to the canvas platform.

Additional information

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Examination information

Examination sub part/s

1. Examination sub part (1/3)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Written examination
Responsible for organisation	decentral
Examination form	Written exam
Examination mode	Analog
Time of examination	Term time
Examination execution	Synchronous
Examination location	On Campus
Grading type	Individual work individual grade
Weighting	40%
Duration	50 mins.

Languages

Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark

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Examination-aid rule

Closed Book

The use of aids is prohibited as a matter of principle, with the exception of pocket calculator models of the Texas Instruments TI-30 series and, in case of non-language exams, bilingual dictionaries without any handwritten notes. Any other aids that are admissible must be explicitly listed by faculty members in the paragraph entitled “Supplementary aids” of the course and examination fact sheet; this list is exhaustive.

Procuring any aids, as well as ensuring their working order, is the exclusive responsibility of students.

Supplementary aids

none.

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2. Examination sub part (2/3)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Presentation
Responsible for organisation	decentral
Examination form	Oral examination
Examination mode	Analog
Time of examination	Term time

Examination execution	Asynchronous
Examination location	On Campus
Grading type	Group work group grade
Weighting	40%
Duration	--

Languages
Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark
Corporate Sustainability Pitch Presentation

Examination-aid rule
Free aids provision

Basically, students are free to choose aids. Any restrictions are defined by the faculty members in charge of the examination under supplementary aids.

Supplementary aids
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3. Examination sub part (3/3)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Active participation
Responsible for organisation	decentral
Examination form	Oral examination
Examination mode	Analog
Time of examination	Term time
Examination execution	Synchronous
Examination location	On Campus
Grading type	Individual work individual grade
Weighting	20%
Duration	--

Languages
Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark
Active participation during the sessions

Examination-aid rule
Free aids provision

Basically, students are free to choose aids. Any restrictions are defined by the faculty members in charge of the examination under supplementary aids.

Supplementary aids
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Content

Throughout the semester, students will collaborate in teams to create a Corporate Sustainability Solutions Pitch. Each team will select an industry and choose either an existing company or a fictional one as the focus of their pitch. The pitch will evaluate the commercial and environmental benefits of the selected corporate sustainability solution, explore strategies for scaling it within the chosen company, and identify potential risks along with mitigation strategies. (Part 1/3: 40%)

Apart from the presentation (Part 1/3) and in-class discussions (Part 3/3: 20% Active Participation), students will complete a mid-class quiz on the overall course themes (Part 2/3; 40% of the grade).

Literature

Selected reading materials will be uploaded to the Canvas platform.

Please note

Please note that only this fact sheet and the examination schedule published at the time of bidding are binding and takes precedence over other information, such as information on StudyNet (Canvas), on lecturers' websites and information in lectures etc.
Any references and links to third-party content within the fact sheet are only of a supplementary, informative nature and lie outside the area of responsibility of the University of St.Gallen.

Documents and materials are only relevant for central examinations if they are available by the end of the lecture period (CW21) at the latest. In the case of centrally organised mid-term examinations, the documents and materials up to CW 13 (Monday, 23rd March 2026) are relevant for testing.

Binding nature of the fact sheets:

- Course information as well as examination date (organised centrally/decentrally) and form of examination: from bidding start in CW 04 (Thursday, 22nd January 2026);
- Examination information (supplementary aids, examination contents, examination literature) for decentralised examinations: in CW 12 (Monday, 16 March 2026);
- Examination information (supplementary aids, examination contents, examination literature) for centrally organised mid-term examinations: in CW 14 (Monday, 30 March 2026);
- Examination information (regulations on aids, examination contents, examination literature) for centrally organised examinations: two weeks before ending with de-registration period in CW 15 (Monday, 06 April 2026).